

HOW DID WE BECOME LOST?

Choosing Self-Rule Instead of Life with God

God made us for received life under His good authority. Adam rebelled, and every accountable sinner chooses the same self-rule.



BIG IDEA

God made humanity for life under His Word. Adam seized self-rule, and every accountable sinner confirms that rebellion.

KEY SCRIPTURE

Genesis 3:1-19

ALSO READ

Romans 1:18-25

MEMORY VERSE

ROMANS 1:25a

"Who changed the truth of God into a lie, and worshipped and served the creature more than the Creator..."

MAIN QUESTION

Why Does Humanity Live Away from Its Creator?

45 MINUTES

S

SESSION SNAPSHOT



A

OPENING ACTIVITY: "WHO GETS THE FINAL WORD?"

1

NAME A RULE YOU WOULD CHANGE (2 MIN)

Invite harmless examples: a school rule, game rule, household routine, or age restriction. Let students explain why they would change it.

2

DISTINGUISH HUMAN AND DIVINE AUTHORITY (2 MIN)

Human rules can be foolish or unjust. God's authority is different: He is the Creator, source of life, and perfectly good. His Word defines what His creation is for.

3

ASK THE DEEPER QUESTION (2 MIN)

Say: The first human rebellion was not simply breaking one rule. Adam and Eve claimed the right to decide good and evil for themselves.

4

OPEN GENESIS 3 (2 MIN)

Ask students to listen for whose word is trusted, who defines what is good, what the humans take, and what they do afterward.

SESSION GOALS

Students should leave understanding:

- God made human life dependent and gave real dominion under His Word.
- Adam did not merely permit rebellion; he actively chose it.
- Self-rule replaces the Creator's authority with the creature's judgment.
- We inherit a world ordered by rebellion and ruled by death.
- Every accountable sinner personally chooses the pattern Adam began.



LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not teach that Adam's personal guilt is transferred to every child. We inherit the rebellious order he established; each accountable sinner becomes personally guilty by choosing rebellion.



PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Markers
- Student handouts
- Review Session 1 bottom line

Sin is not merely breaking a rule. It is the creature claiming the Creator's authority.

HOW DID WE BECOME LOST?

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B CORE TEACHING

1 GOD GAVE RECEIVED LIFE Gen. 1:26-28

Humanity received life, identity, dominion, and purpose from God. Adam's authority was real, but it remained entrusted authority under God's Word.

EMPHASIZE: Dependence was created good, not a defect.

2 ADAM SEIZED SELF-RULE Gen. 3:1-7

The serpent questioned God's Word. Adam and Eve judged the tree by their own desire, took what God withheld, and claimed the right to define good and evil.

EMPHASIZE: Adam actively rebelled; he did not merely fail to prevent it.

3 REBELLION REORDERED THE WORLD Gen. 3:8-19

Fellowship gave way to hiding, trust to accusation, stewardship to conflict, and mortal life to inevitable death. Adam's dominion became a world in rebellion.

EMPHASIZE: The rebellion did not make death possible; it made death inevitable.

4 EACH SINNER CONFIRMS IT Rom. 1:18-25

People encounter God's truth yet suppress it, exchange it, and serve the creature. Every accountable sinner personally repeats Adam's claim to self-rule.

EMPHASIZE: We inherit Adam's world; we become guilty through our own rebellion.

M THE MOVEMENT OF SELF-RULE

1 GOD SPEAKS

2 THE WORD IS QUESTIONED

3 DESIRE DEFINES GOOD

4 THE CREATURE SEIZES

SELF-RULE PROMISES INDEPENDENCE BUT PRODUCES HIDING, BLAME, BONDAGE, AND DEATH.

? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1 What good things did Adam receive before Genesis 3?

Follow-up: Why does received authority differ from self-rule?

2 Where do you see the choice of self-rule in Genesis 3?

Follow-up: Whose word and judgment control the decision?

3 Why is sin deeper than breaking a rule?

Follow-up: What authority does the sinner claim?

4 What changed in the world after Adam's rebellion?

Follow-up: Trace hiding, blame, conflict, and death.

5 How does Romans 1 show people repeating Adam's choice?

Follow-up: What truth is suppressed or exchanged?

! WEEKLY REFLECTION

Notice moments when you want the final word about what is good, true, or right.

- What had God already said?
- What did your own desire say?
- Which authority did you choose?

+ PRIVATE CONVERSATION

If you recognize that you have been living under your own authority, you do not need to make a public speech. Ask a leader to help you see from Scripture what it means to surrender to Christ.

N LEADER NOTES

- Keep God and Adam distinct.
- Use rebellion, not the Fall.
- Do not imply transferred guilt.
- Name personal responsibility.
- Point ahead to the faithful Christ.

Adam began the rebellion. Every accountable sinner chooses to join it.